

From Invisible to Interview-Ready

The Job Search Roadmap by Lodestar

Most people start their job search by sending CVs. That's already the wrong move. This is the roadmap I wish someone had given me — built from my own search, my clients' wins, and every painful lesson in between.

PHASE 1

Get Clear Before You Apply

Define your target role

Not 3 different roles — one primary target. Write it in one sentence: the title, the industry, the type of company. Clarity beats volume every time.

Audit your gap

List the skills the role requires. Honestly mark which ones you have. The gap is your prep list, not a reason to give up.

Build your positioning statement

Two sentences: who you are professionally, what you deliver, and for whom. This becomes the backbone of your CV summary, LinkedIn headline, and every cover letter.

PHASE 2

Fix Your Materials

Rewrite your CV for this specific role

One tailored CV beats ten generic ones. Mirror the job description language. Lead with impact, not duties. Cut anything older than 10 years unless directly relevant.

Optimize your LinkedIn before you apply

70% of recruiters check LinkedIn before responding. Your headline, About section, and top 3 experiences must tell the same story as your CV.

Prepare 3 versions of your story

A 30-second intro, a 2-minute professional narrative, and a written bio. You will use all three.

PHASE 3

Apply with Strategy, Not Volume

Target 5–10 roles at a time, not 50

Mass applying kills your energy and your follow-through. Apply to roles you genuinely want and are qualified for. Quality over quantity — always.

Track every application

Use a simple tracker: company, role, date applied, status, next action. This keeps you proactive instead of anxious and waiting.

Follow up within 5–7 business days

A short, professional follow-up email doubles your response rate. Most candidates never send one. Be the one who does.

PHASE 4

Prepare to Win the Interview

Research the company deeply

Not just the website — look at recent news, leadership changes, LinkedIn posts from the hiring manager, and Glassdoor reviews.

Prepare your STAR stories

Situation, Task, Action, Result. Have 5–7 ready. They will cover 90% of behavioral questions across all interviews.

Prepare your closing questions

The interview ends with 'do you have questions for us?' — your answer here can win or lose the role. Prepare 3 thoughtful, specific ones.

PHASE 5

Negotiate and Close

Never accept on the spot

Always ask for time to review. 'I'm very excited — can I have until [date] to review and get back to you?' is always acceptable.

Know your number before you need it

Research market rates before the offer comes. LinkedIn Salary, Glassdoor, and industry forums are your benchmarks.

Negotiate everything, not just base salary

Remote days, start date, title, performance review timing — all of it is on the table in the right conversation.

LODESTAR

Find your direction. Own your story.

lodestarcareers.co | guide@lodestarcareers.co